UNITED STATES · WORKS OFFLINE

Your emergency USB drive

A guide for Windows and Android · reviewed Nov 9, 2026

This package contains short guides for emergencies. You can open it without internet. Follow current local alerts and responders first.

Five steps to a ready drive

1

Extract the package
Download the U.S. ZIP file. Open it in Downloads and choose Extract or Extract All.

2

Copy everything to the USB drive
Copy all files and folders from the extracted folder. START.html and this PDF should be directly on the USB drive.

3

Open the start page
Open START.html from the drive. On Android, use your Files app. If that does not work, open Guides and read a .txt file.

4

Add your own files
My-Files has space for photos, maps, documents, and local information. Put sensitive files only in an encrypted vault you have tested.

5

Test offline and make a second copy
Turn off internet for a test. Open one guide and copy a harmless test file back to your device. Make a second full copy and keep it elsewhere.

Important: a ZIP file alone on the USB drive is not enough. Copy the files **from the extracted folder**. If a step is unclear, go through this guide again or test the drive with someone you trust.

What is in each folder?

The names on the drive describe what belongs there. You can open each folder in File Explorer or your phone's Files app.

START.html	Start page with search and short situation guides.
Guides	The same guidance as regular .txt files. Use these if the start page will not open on your phone.
My-Files	Folders for your Photos, Maps, Documents, and Local-Info. They start empty; README.txt explains each one.
Private-Files	Instructions for encrypting sensitive files. No vault or passwords are included.
Infrastructure	Sources, license, detailed project information, and code. You do not need this folder for ordinary use.

If something will not open

Open the drive in File Explorer or your Files app. In Guides, choose a .txt file for the situation. Test this on your own devices before you need the drive.

Keep personal photos and documents out of the public GitHub repository. Add sensitive documents only after successful encryption and recovery tests.

Digital copies do not replace original documents. Current local alerts and orders take priority over this offline package.

Copy the package to your drive

Choose the section for the device you have.

With a Windows computer

1. Open Downloads in File Explorer. Right-click the ZIP you downloaded and choose Extract All.

2. Open the extracted folder. You should see START.html, 00-READ-ME-US.pdf, Guides, and My-Files.

3. Plug in the USB drive and open it under This PC in File Explorer. Check any files already on the drive before copying.

4. Select everything inside the extracted folder with Ctrl + A and copy with Ctrl + C. Open the USB drive and paste with Ctrl + V.

5. Wait until copying is finished. Open START.html from the drive and read one file from Guides.

With an Android phone only

1. Open Downloads in your Files app. Tap the ZIP and choose Extract or Unzip.

2. Connect a compatible USB drive or adapter. Open USB storage in your Files app.

3. Select all files and folders inside the extracted folder. Choose Copy, then choose USB storage as the destination.

4. Open START.html from the drive. If your phone cannot open local HTML, read a .txt file in Guides.

Your files and upkeep

The drive is most useful after you add the files your household needs and test how to get them back.

What you can add

Photos: your own pictures. Maps: offline maps you may lawfully keep. Documents: your own non-sensitive files. Local-Info: a personal copy of the blank template, filled with checked local information.

A contact list, charger, suitable adapter, and flashlight may also help. Digital document copies do not replace originals.

Sensitive files

IDs, health information, and other sensitive details belong only in an encrypted vault you have actually opened and tested on Windows and Android. Instructions are in Private-Files/README.txt.

Keep the password and recovery key away from the drive. The public package contains no personal data, passwords, or keys.

How much storage?

Check the size of your files and add about one third as spare room. For 5 GB of files, consider 16-32 GB; for 35 GB, about 64 GB; for 140 GB, about 256 GB. Usable space may be lower than the label.

Check that the USB connector and any adapter fit your devices. A matching plug alone does not guarantee your phone can read the drive.

Two copies and a recovery test

Make a second complete copy and keep it in another place. Check both after changes and regularly, for example every three months.

Copy a harmless test file from the drive back to your device and open the returned copy. That tests the recovery path on your own device.